

Wall Street Millionaires

B. C. Forbes

“**W**hat sort of men are your Wall Street millionaires?” I was asked the other day.

“How long is a railroad journey?” I felt like replying, but didn’t. Instead, I merely said: “Very much like other people.”

“But aren’t they horribly uncouth? I always thought they were terribly uncultured—and worse.”

“Not at all,” I replied in defense of a much-maligned class. “Some of them are among the finest men in America.”

“You surely do not mean that? Do they really possess a full measure of the virtues?”

I assured the questioner that, taking them as a class, they did.

“Wall Street millionaires” are not all a pack of wolves seeking whom they may devour.

The term “Wall Street” is more elastic than a rubber band. It embraces anything—in the popular imagination—from the get-rich-thievishly fraternity, who never see Wall Street, to the strongest of our financiers and banking institutions. “Wall Street millionaires” include alike the spectacular speculators who have made fortunes in sheer gambling and the most conservative of our bankers and local capitalists.

How many men have made—and retained—millions SOLELY through stock speculation. Not many.